

## README

"Housing Market Spillovers: Evidence from the End of Rent Control in Cambridge Massachusetts"

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See the Data Appendix (in the Online Appendix) for more details on the data compilation process.

### **Data files** (folder /dta)

The dta subdirectory contains all of the publicly available data used in the paper:

- *assess-panel-1994-2001-2004.dta* provides a panel of the 1995, 2002, and 2005 Cambridge Assessor's databases for residential properties in Cambridge, reflecting valuations corresponding to 1994, 2001, 2004, respectively.
- *building-permits-data.dta* is a panel of residential properties in each year, with data on whether they had an associated building permit that year and for how much. It is a cleaned version of the building permits database found in *Cambridge Building Permits Database.xlsx*.
- *Cambridge Assessor's Database 1994.dta* is a copy of the full 1995 Tax Commitment database, hand entered from a scanned copy.
- *Cambridge Building Permits Database.xlsx* is the copy of the building permits database as given to us by Cambridge Inspectional Services.
- *Cambridge City Census.zip* is a folder containing a digitized version of the Cambridge City Census from 1991-2000 containing resident names, voter registration status, addresses, etc.
- *census-bg-data.dta* contains information from the 1990 Decennial Census STF1 and STF3 files at the block group level.
- *Somerville-Border-BGs.dta* and *Somerville-Border-Tracts.dta* are a list of Somerville block groups and tracts that are on the Cambridge, Medford, or Mystic River borders.
- *structures-2001.dta* is a copy of the 2002 census of structures provided by Cambridge City Hall, geocoded with census geography identifiers and merged with rent control and rent control intensity information for each residential parcel in the City of Cambridge.

### **Do files** (folder /do)

The do file directory contains a do file for each figure or table in the paper (including appendix and online appendix). Each file is labeled with the name of the table that it creates. Many of these programs will not run because the data that is used to create the corresponding tables or graphs is proprietary. However, this data can be purchased from the Warren Group or from Equifax.

*sales-data-clean.do* cleans the raw transactions data the Warren Group collected from the registry of deeds. Its primary purpose is to detect non-arms-length transactions. See the Data Appendix for more details.

**GIS files** (folder /gis)

The gis subdirectory contains the necessary shape files to plot all parcels in Cambridge and was provided by the City of Cambridge GIS Department to the MIT GIS Library. Merging with the ML code in the TaxFY08 (Assessor's database for 2008) gives extra detail on each address point.